# Who to Ask What

Fifteen questions for your father, the main caregiver, the family and the professionals, with room to write what each one says.

Some of what's going wrong with your father's care is a question for your sister. Some of it is a question for him, and some for the doctor's office. Take each question to the person it belongs to, ask it as it's written, and put the answer on the lines underneath.

This guide doesn't answer the questions and doesn't put them in order of importance. The answers belong to the people below.

## Your father

All of this is about his days. Ask him first, and write his answers the way he says them.

1. What is working for you at the moment, and what isn't?

2. What concerns you most about how things are going?

3. Is there anything that's meant to happen in your week that hasn't been happening?

## Your sister, or whoever does most of the day-to-day

Find ten minutes when nobody else is listening, and mostly listen.

1. Which tasks can't continue the way they are?

2. What has to change right away, and what can you keep doing for now?

3. What do you need from the rest of us?

## The rest of the family

One person at a time, so each answer gets written down before the next one starts.

1. What is your main concern, and can you give one example of what happened?
2. What do you think is not getting done?
3. Is this about his care, about how we communicate, about paperwork, or about how the work is shared?
4. Where do you remember something differently from someone else in the family?
5. Which concerns should we talk about on the next call, and which can stay on the open list?

## The doctor's office or the nurse

1. We've written down what we've noticed at home, with the dates. Which of it would you like to hear about?

## The pharmacist or the prescriber

1. These are our questions about his medications. Can you go through them with us?

## Your care consultant

Someone who brings the tasks that are slipping, the load on the main caregiver and the family's disagreements into one conversation.

1. We've listed our concerns with an example for each. What else would you want to know?
2. We don't all see the question of a move, or of more help, the same way. What would you want to hear from each of us?

**What this guide doesn't do**

It doesn't answer these questions, rank them, or say whose account is right. If one of them feels pressing to you, tell the person you're asking. For an emergency, call emergency services.

## Ready for the next step?

You know which questions to ask and whom to ask, and soon you'll have some answers. The care interview gives those answers somewhere to go: it walks you through your father's situation area by area and turns what you tell it into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

**Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›**

### WHERE THIS COMES FROM

Several of these questions echo the sample agenda in the Family Caregiver Alliance's guide to holding a family meeting: what the person wants and needs, what support the primary caregiver needs, and which tasks need doing. The grouping by person is ours.

1. Family Caregiver Alliance, Holding a Family Meeting